



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,
Gnóthaí Baile agus Imirce
Department of Justice,
Home Affairs and Migration

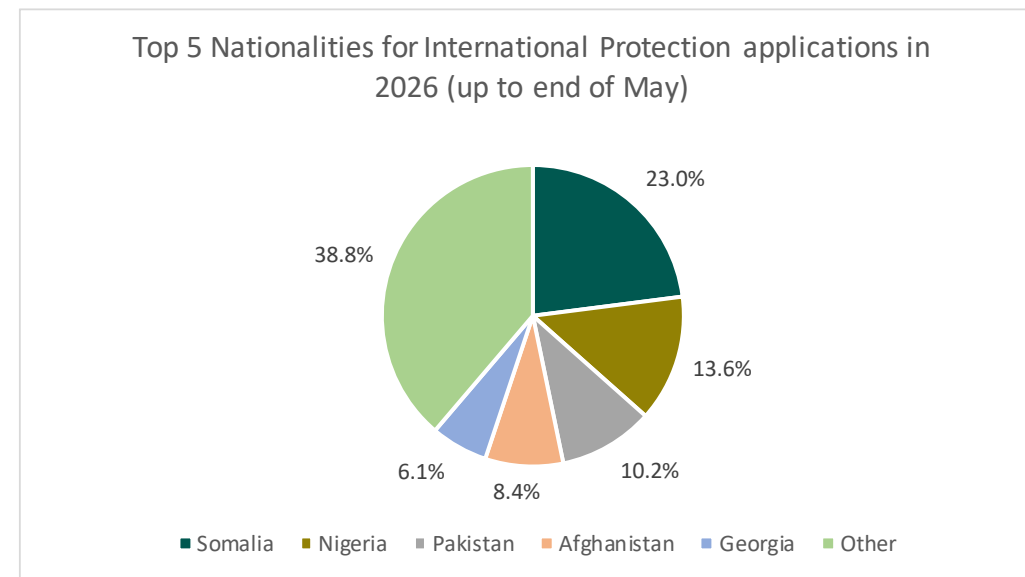
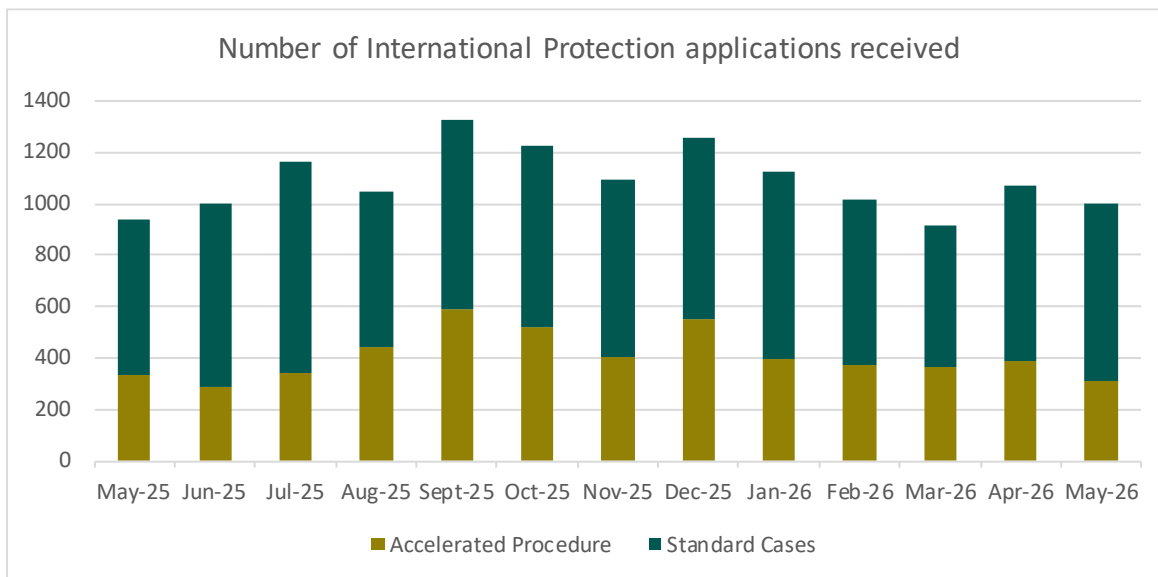
International Protection: May 2026

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 8th June 2026. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for May 2026:

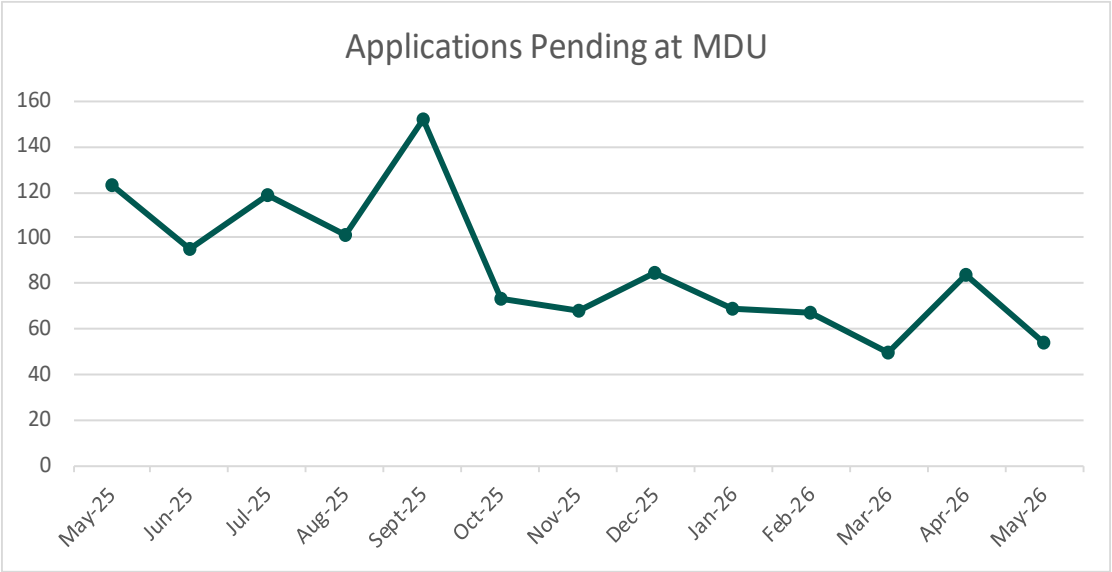
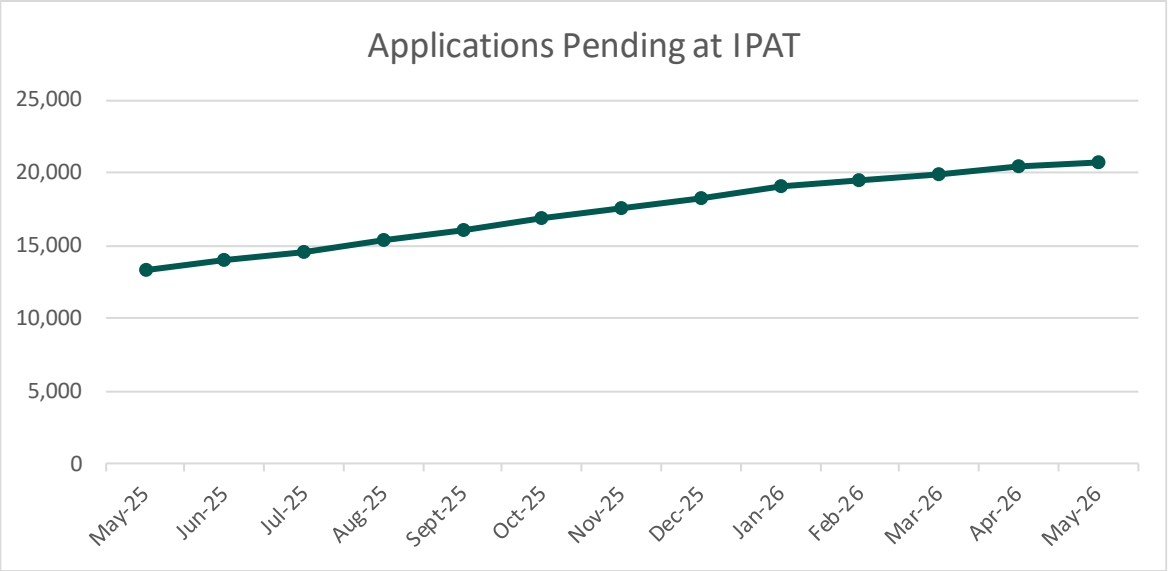
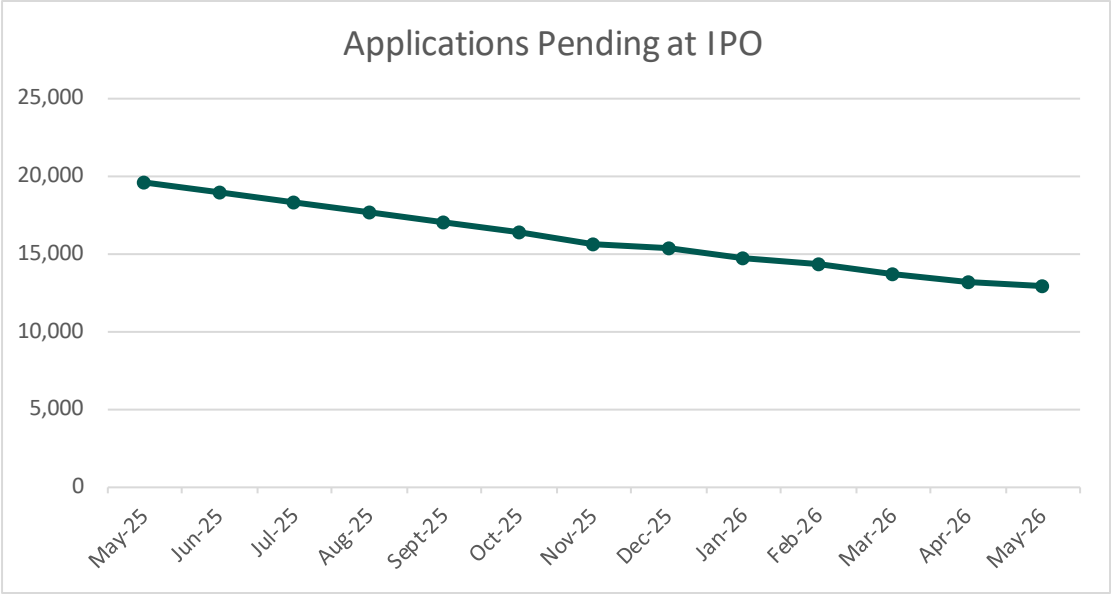
- As of May this year, the number of asylum applications has risen slightly compared to last year. In May 2026 there were 1,005 applications compared to 941 in May 2025
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (1,180 applications), Nigeria (699), Pakistan (523), Afghanistan (429) and Georgia (314)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,863. As of May this year, there were 12,869 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been a decrease in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In May 2026, 1,333 cases were closed off compared to 1,522 in May 2025
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has remained steady. In May 2026, the median processing time to determination was 76 weeks (compared to 76 weeks in November 2025 and 79 weeks in February 2026)
- The number of staff in the IPO has decreased slightly to 609.5 at the end of May 2026
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in May 2026 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 59% of decisions were refusals, 1% permission to remain, and 40% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



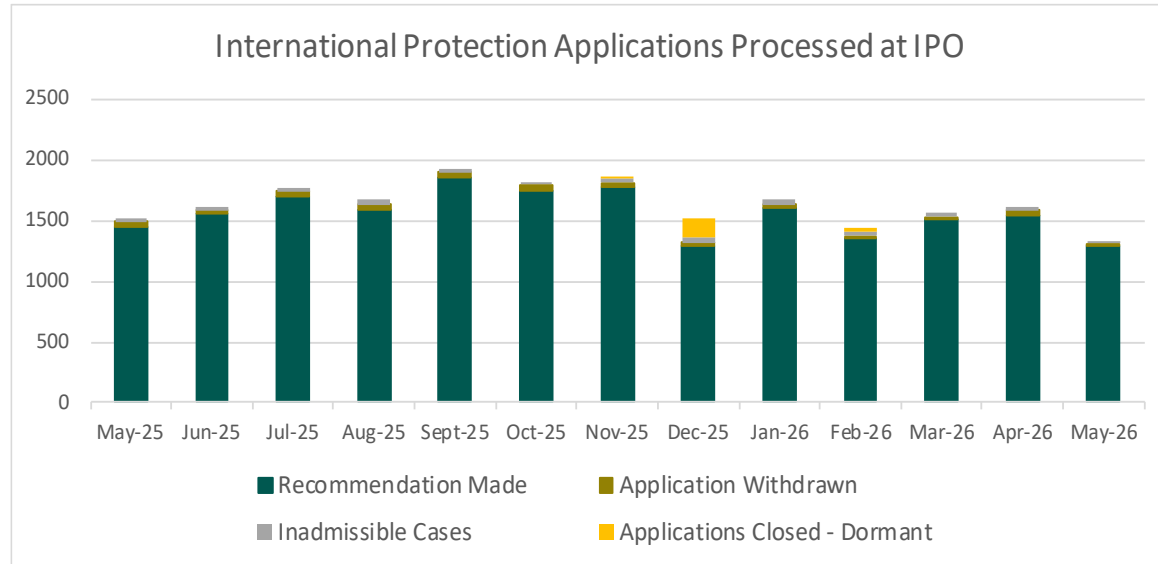
- In May 2026 there were 1,005 applications received for asylum. This is up from 941 last May
- The total number of applications in May 2026 that fell under accelerated procedure was 308 (which represents 31% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (1,180 applications), Nigeria (699), Pakistan (523), Afghanistan (429) and Georgia (314)

Pending International Protection Applications

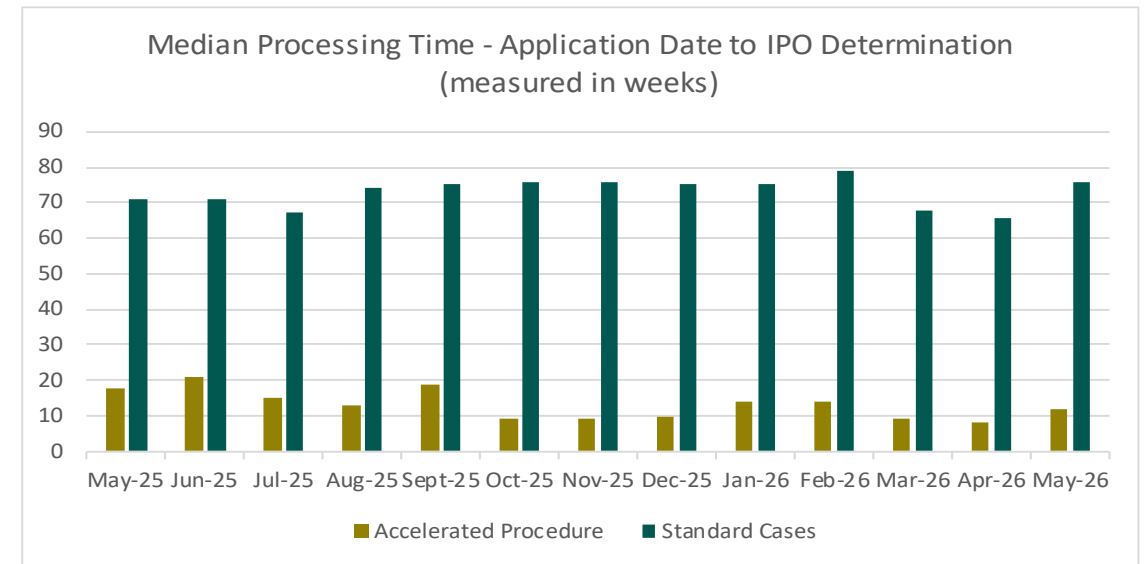


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 12,869. The numbers have been reducing since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In May 2026, there were 20,754 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of May 2026 is 54

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

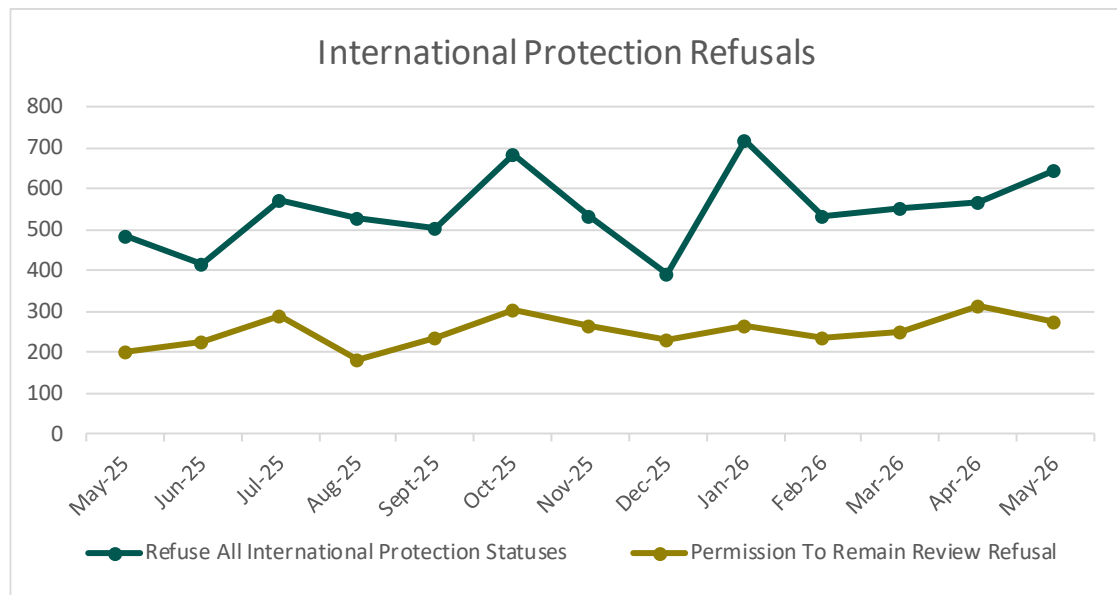
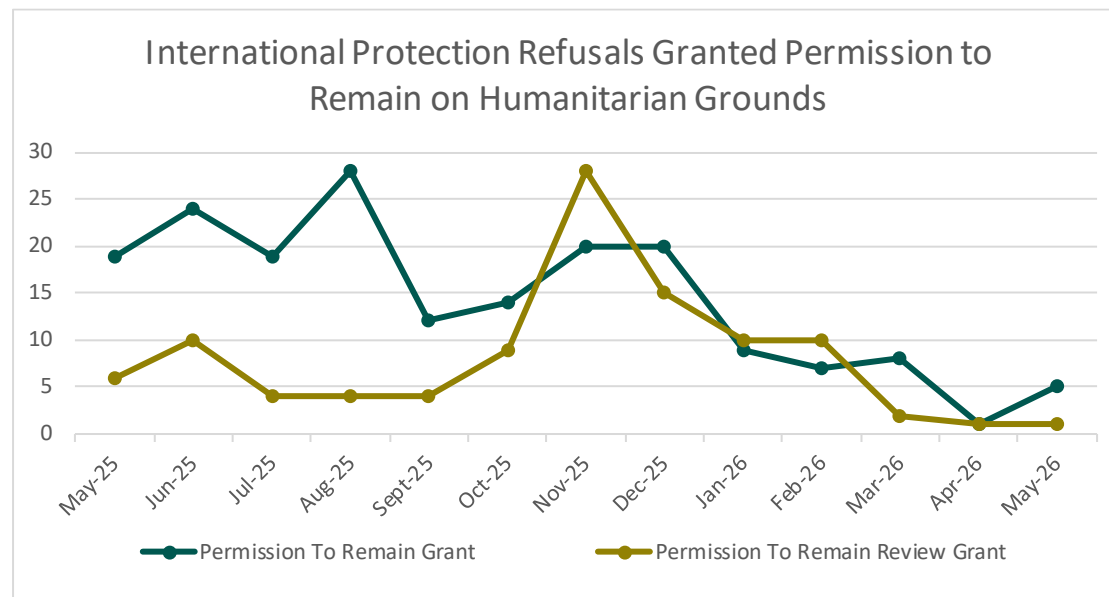
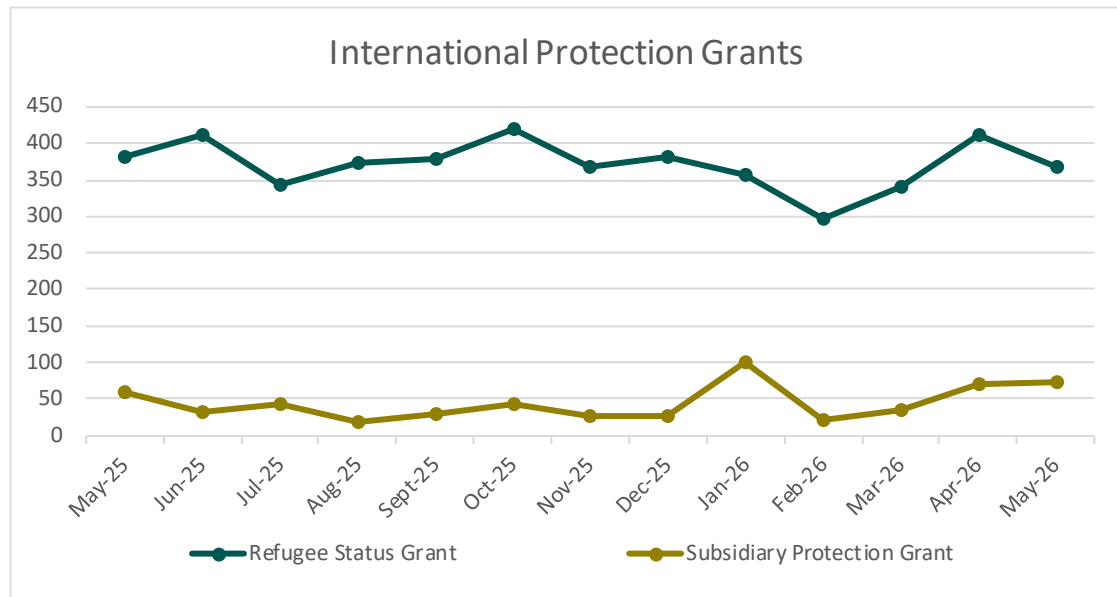


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible, Applications Withdrawn and Dormant Applications
- In May 2026, 1,333 cases were closed off. This is down from 1,568 in March and 1,608 in April
- 2026 YTD applications processed were 7,629 (a 5.1% decrease on 8,040 applications processed for 2025)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been remaining steady for Standard Cases. The median processing time for cases under the Accelerated Procedure have decreased compared to the first half of 2025.
- In May 2026, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 76 weeks (the same as 76 weeks in November 2025 and down from 79 weeks in February 2026)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 12 weeks in May 2026, up from 9 weeks in March and 8 weeks in April 2026

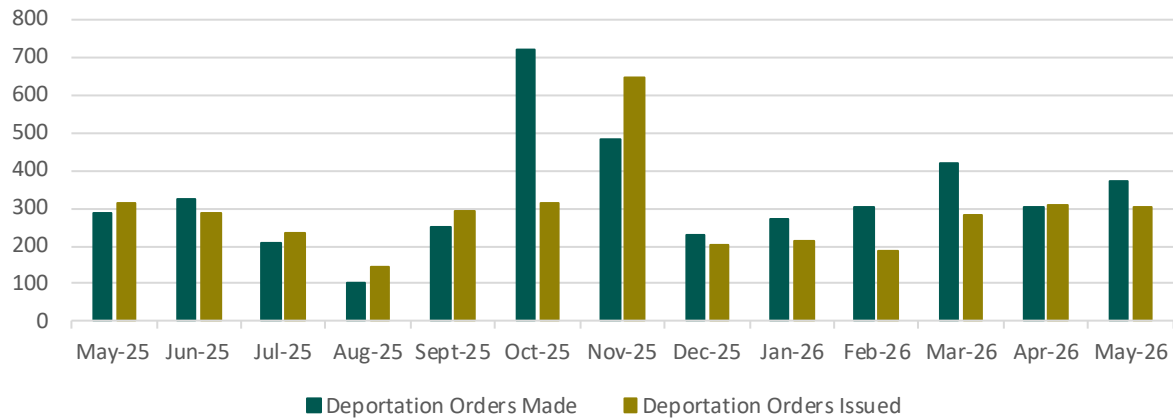
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In May 2026, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 369 were given refugee status grant and 73 subsidiary protection grant (442 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 5 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 1 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months however it appears to be trending down
- There were 647 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 275 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall, for May 2026, 59% of decisions were refusals, 1% permission to remain, and 40% were international protection grants

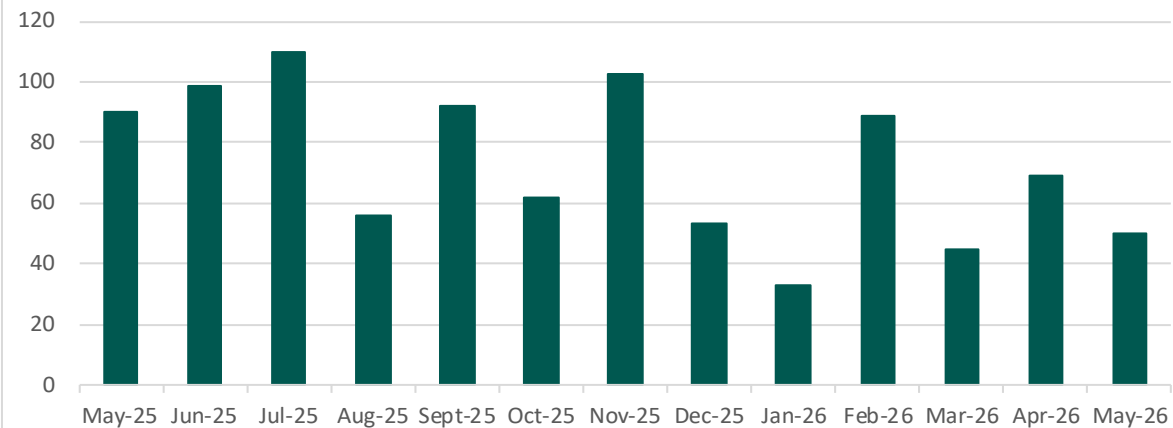
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

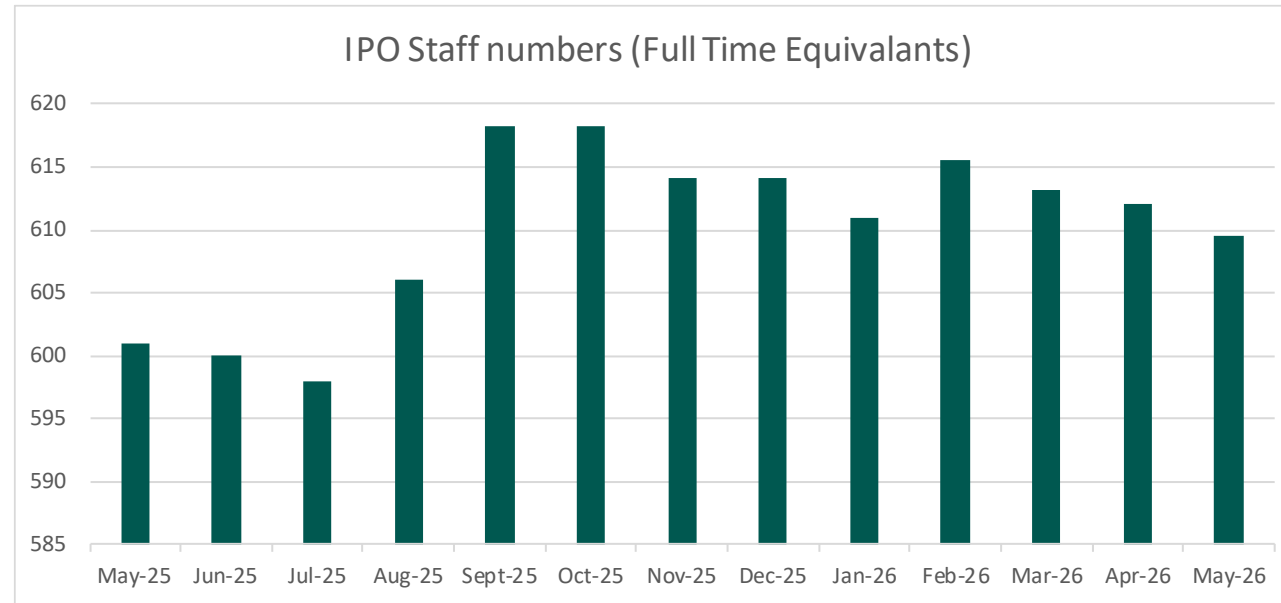


- For May 2026 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 370 and the number of deportation orders issued was 301. For April, the figures were 305 and 310, and for March, the figures were 421 and 284, respectively
- For May 2026 the number of removals was 50

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In May 2025 there were 601 FTEs in IPO. This number has been generally trending upwards with some fluctuations, to 613.1 in March and 612.1 in April 2026.
- At the end of May 2026, the IPO had 609.5 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

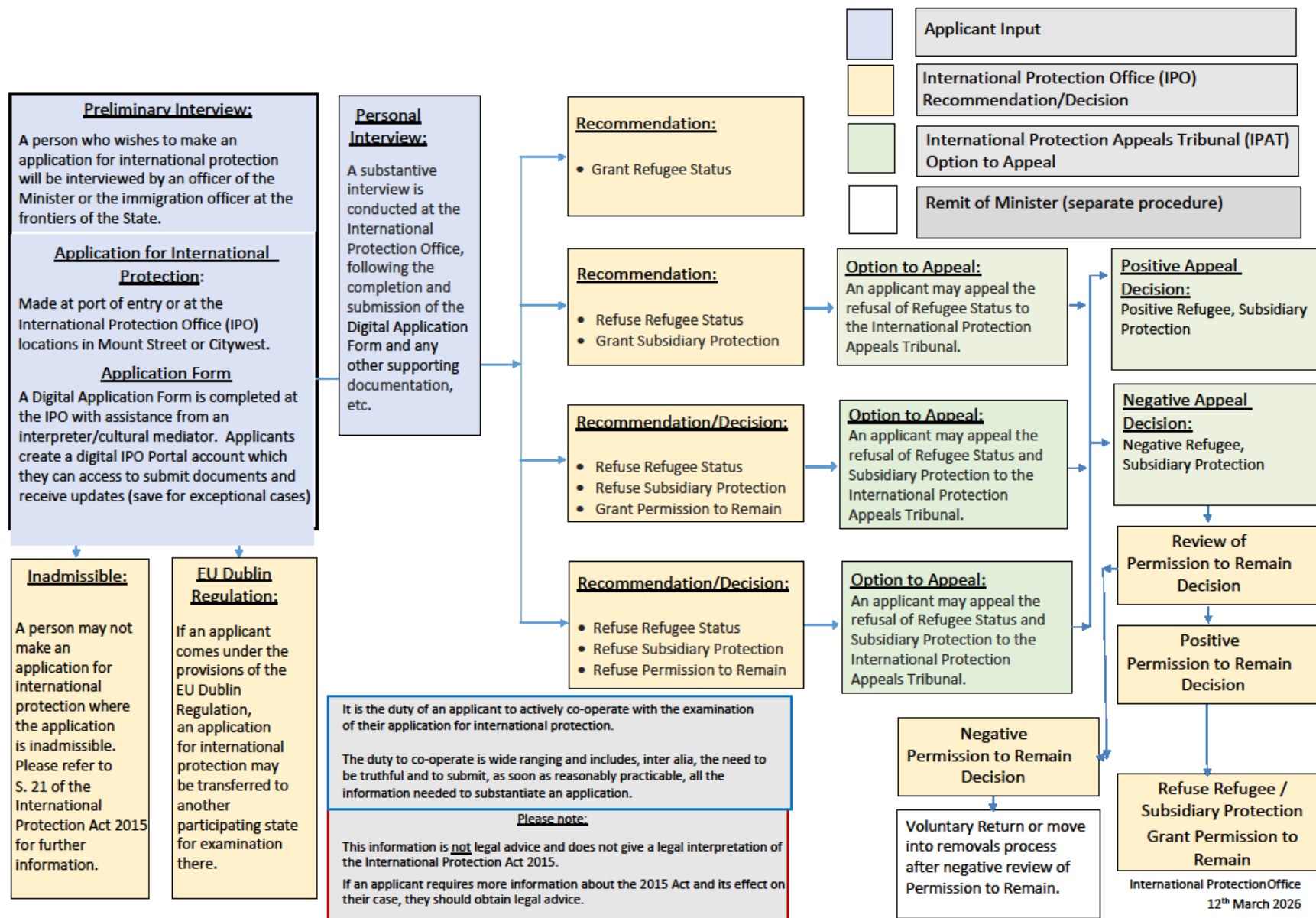
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
Accelerated Procedure	333	285	344	440	589	519	400	549	397	375	368	385	308
Standard Cases	608	716	821	609	736	704	692	708	726	642	551	688	697

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2025 to date	Applications	%
Somalia	1180	23.0%
Nigeria	699	13.6%
Pakistan	523	10.2%
Afghanistan	429	8.4%
Georgia	314	6.1%
Other	1992	38.8%
Total	5137	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

IPO Pending	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
IP Pending	19,551	18,922	18,323	17,676	17,021	16,402	15,620	15,315	14,741	14,332	13,691	13,194	12,869
Leg Pending	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
IPAT Pending	13393	14035	14529	15397	16067	16958	17579	18243	19076	19570	19969	20469	20754

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

MDU Pending	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
Total	123	95	119	101	152	73	68	85	69	67	50	84	54

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
Recommendation Made	1451	1550	1697	1587	1856	1740	1773	1290	1606	1347	1507	1544	1284
Application Withdrawn	41	31	40	40	40	51	41	29	25	25	19	42	27
Inadmissible Cases	30	26	29	40	28	23	39	41	50	37	42	22	22
Applications Closed - Dormant	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	157	0	30	0	0	0

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
Accelerated Procedure	18	21	15	13	19	9	9	10	14	14	9	8	12
Standard Cases	71	71	67	74	75	76	76	75	75	79	68	65.5	76

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
Refugee Status Grant	382	413	344	374	379	420	367	382	358	297	341	411	369
Subsidiary Protection Grante	58	32	43	18	28	44	26	27	100	22	35	71	73
Permissio to Remain Grant	19	24	19	28	12	14	20	20	9	7	8	1	5
Permission to Remain Review Grant	6	10	4	4	4	9	28	15	10	10	2	1	1

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	482	418	571	527	503	685	535	392	719	534	553	566	647
Permission to Remain Review Refusal	200	228	290	184	236	306	267	232	263	235	252	316	275

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
Deportation Orders Made	288	324	206	105	250	721	484	230	273	302	421	305	370
Deportation Orders Issued	316	288	235	147	292	312	646	205	212	187	284	310	301

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

Enforcements/Returns	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
Total	90	99	110	56	92	62	103	53	33	89	45	69	50

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
IPO Staffing Level	601	600	598	606	618.2	618.2	614.2	614.2	611	615.6	613.1	612.1	609.5